
Topics: 16.2 Line Integrals (Second Part); 16.3 The Fundamental Theorem for Line Integrals

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1. Evaluate the vector line integral.

(a) $\int_C y \, dx + 2x \, dy$, where C is parametrized by $x = 3t$, $y = t^2$ with $0 \leq t \leq 1$.

(b) $\int_C x \, dx + y \, dy + x^2 y \, dz$, where C is given by $\mathbf{r}(t) = \langle \cos t, \sin t, t \rangle$ with $0 \leq t \leq \frac{\pi}{2}$.

2. Evaluate $\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{r}$, where $\mathbf{F}(x, y) = xy^2 \mathbf{i} - x^2 \mathbf{j}$ and C is given by $\mathbf{r}(t) = t^3 \mathbf{i} + t^2 \mathbf{j}$ with $0 \leq t \leq 1$.
3. Find the work done by the force field

$$\mathbf{F}(x, y) = y^2 \mathbf{i} - y \sin x \mathbf{j}$$

in moving an object along the curve $x = y^2 + 2$ from $(2, 0)$ to $(6, 2)$.

4. Determine whether the vector field $\mathbf{F}$ is conservative. If it is, find a function f with $\mathbf{F} = \nabla f$.

(a) $\mathbf{F}(x, y) = (xy + y^2) \mathbf{i} + (x^2 + 2xy) \mathbf{j}$

(b) $\mathbf{F}(x, y) = ye^x \mathbf{i} + (e^x + e^y) \mathbf{j}$

5. (a) Show that the vector field $\mathbf{F}(x, y) = (1 + xy)e^{xy} \mathbf{i} + x^2 e^{xy} \mathbf{j}$ is conservative and find a potential function f for $\mathbf{F}$.

(b) Evaluate $\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{r}$, where C is given by $\mathbf{r}(t) = \cos t \mathbf{i} + 2 \sin t \mathbf{j}$ with $0 \leq t \leq \frac{\pi}{2}$.

6. Show that the vector line integral $\int_C \sin y \, dx + (x \cos y - \sin y) \, dy$ is independent of path, where C is any piecewise smooth curve from $(2, 0)$ to $(1, \pi)$. Then evaluate the integral.

7. Use the Fundamental Theorem of Line Integrals to find the work done by the force field

$$\mathbf{F}(x, y, z) = (ze^y + \cos y) \mathbf{i} + (xze^y - x \sin y) \mathbf{j} + (xe^y - 2z) \mathbf{k}$$

in moving an object along a piecewise smooth path from $(0, 3, 2)$ to $(1, 0, 2)$.

SOME USEFUL DEFINITIONS, THEOREMS, AND NOTATION

Vector Fields. A vector field $\mathbf{F}$ is a **gradient field** if there exists a function f such that

$$\mathbf{F} = \nabla f.$$

In this case, $\mathbf{F}$ is also said to be **conservative**, and f is called a **potential function** for $\mathbf{F}$.

Vector Line Integrals. Let C be a smooth curve given by the vector function $\mathbf{r}$ with $a \leq t \leq b$, and let $\mathbf{F}$ be a continuous vector field. The **vector line integral** of $\mathbf{F}$ along C is

$$\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{r} = \int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{T} \, ds = \int_a^b \mathbf{F}(\mathbf{r}(t)) \cdot \mathbf{r}'(t) \, dt.$$

If $\mathbf{F}(x, y, z) = P(x, y, z)\mathbf{i} + Q(x, y, z)\mathbf{j} + R(x, y, z)\mathbf{k}$, then we also write

$$\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{r} = \int_C P \, dx + Q \, dy + R \, dz$$

and similarly for a curve and vector field in two dimensions.

Work. The **work** done by a force field $\mathbf{F}$ in moving an object along a curve C is

$$W = \int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{r}.$$

The Fundamental Theorem for Line Integrals. Let C be a piecewise smooth curve given by $\mathbf{r}(t)$, $a \leq t \leq b$, and suppose that $\mathbf{F} = \nabla f$ for some function f . Assume that $\mathbf{F}$ is continuous. Then

$$\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{r} = \int_C \nabla f \cdot d\mathbf{r} = f(\mathbf{r}(b)) - f(\mathbf{r}(a)).$$

Suggested Textbook Problems

Section 16.2 (Second Part): 5-8, 14-24, 29-32, 34, 41-46

Section 16.3: 1-36, 41